27 Oct 2026 02:34:36 ET | 16 pages

DigitalOcean Holdings, Inc. (DOCN.N)

3Q26E Preview: Plenty to Like Against Compelling Risk/Reward

CITI'S TAKE

With shares -25% in Oct over fears of neocloud debt/ability to service obligations (vs. neocloud avg -35%), DOCN offers a compelling set-up into 3Q26 results (11/3). While we can appreciate the concern, we argue DOCN is in a fundamentally different operating position vs. neoclouds which helps insulate them from these risks, especially given an improved balance sheet (PF net leverage of 0.7x), limited customer concentration, shorter-duration contracts, and emerging value-added services offering. This, together with resilient demand that is visible in the growing momentum of large deals and healthy pricing trajectory (GPU spot price up MSD since 2Q26 report), underwrites conviction for topline upside against an undemanding 3Q26E set up and scope for the company to update and lift CY27 rev growth guide (currently 50%+). Net, healthy readthroughs on demand help underwrite conviction on topline acceleration in 2H26E and durable 40%+ CAGR, offering an attractive risk/reward into results. Reaffirm Buy.

Focus points for the print and our view — 1) Sources and availability of funding for upcoming capacity buildouts: While management has consistently indicated continued access to capital at attractive rates, details on funding may be a key focal point given the recent developments in the AI infrastructure space. 2) Path to 40%+ growth exiting CY26E: DOCN generally guides conservatively and we see scope for the company to deliver 40%+ growth exiting CY26E, especially given healthy demand trends/readthroughs. 3) Updates to CY27 revenue guidance: we believe pieces are in place for management to update and raise current CY27E revenue growth guide of 50%+ (visibility for stronger CY26E exit rate; RPO trajectory; pricing upside). 4) Implied non-AI cohort ARR trajectory is healthy: 2Q26 suggest non-AI customer ARR growth re-accelerated, offering further support for the company to achieve 40%+ growth exiting CY26.

Buy	
Price (26 Oct 26 16:00)	US$99.53
Target price	US$190.00
Expected share price return	90.9%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	90.9%
Market Cap	US$11,703M

Price Performance
(RIC: DOCN.N, BB: DOCN US)



EPS (US$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	0.56A	0.59A	0.54A	0.44A	2.13A	2.12A	2.13A
2026E	**0.44A**	**0.45A**	**0.30E**	**0.23E**	**1.40E**	**1.46E**	**1.47E**
Previous	0.44A	0.45A	0.30E	0.23E	1.40E	na	na
2027E	**0.40E**	**0.51E**	**0.59E**	**0.66E**	**2.15E**	**1.84E**	**1.73E**
Previous	0.40E	0.51E	0.59E	0.66E	2.15E	na	na
2028E	**0.76E**	**0.93E**	**1.07E**	**1.18E**	**3.94E**	**2.96E**	**2.99E**
Previous	0.76E	0.93E	1.07E	1.18E	3.94E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click here for Visible Alpha consensus data

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DOCN.N: Fiscal year end 31-Dec

Price: US$99.53; TP: US$190.00; Market Cap: US$11,703m; Recomm: Buy

Profit & Loss (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	780.6	901.4	1,180.0	1,860.1	2,960.5
Cost of sales	-289.9	-344.7	-556.1	-911.8	-1,412.2
Gross profit	490.7	556.7	623.9	948.3	1,548.3
Gross Margin (%)	62.9	61.8	52.9	51.0	52.3
EBITDA (Adj)	**328.5**	**374.8**	**465.5**	**745.3**	**1,202.6**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	42.1	41.6	39.5	40.1	40.6
Depreciation	-130.1	-137.4	-261.7	-390.1	-568.4
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**220.8**	**257.4**	**223.9**	**375.5**	**654.5**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	28.3	28.6	19.0	20.2	22.1
Net interest	6.7	49.7	-27.0	-51.8	-76.9
Associates	0	0	0	0	0
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	-129.8	-100.4	-138.1	-208.7	-318.9
Pre-tax profit	**97.7**	**206.7**	**58.8**	**115.0**	**258.6**
Tax	-13.2	52.6	-0.4	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0
Reported net profit	**84.5**	**259.3**	**58.4**	**115.0**	**258.6**
Net Margin (%)	10.8	28.8	4.9	6.2	8.7
Core NPAT	195.9	223.2	172.1	271.9	485.1

Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Reported EPS ($)	0.82	2.47	0.48	0.91	2.10
Core EPS ($)	1.91	2.13	1.40	2.15	3.94
DPS ($)	0	0	0	0	0
CFPS ($)	2.76	2.95	3.08	5.84	9.66
FCFPS ($)	0.94	1.62	1.25	4.00	6.82
BVPS ($)	-2.17	-0.31	11.83	14.05	18.94
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	94	91	124	126	123
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	102	105	123	126	123

Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue (%)	12.7	15.5	30.9	57.6	59.2
EBIT (Adj) (%)	23.9	16.6	-13.0	67.7	74.3
Core NPAT (%)	17.6	13.9	-22.9	58.0	78.4
Core EPS (%)	20.2	11.2	-34.0	53.4	83.1

Balance Sheet (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Cash & cash equiv.	428.4	254.5	1,687.5	3,252.9	3,473.0
Accounts receivables	72.5	90.9	143.3	173.7	202.8
Inventory	0	0	0	0	0
Net fixed & other tangibles	443.0	691.7	2,486.4	3,828.9	3,609.8
Goodwill & intangibles	654.3	719.0	949.7	949.7	949.7
Financial & other assets	40.8	81.6	119.9	128.6	142.1
Total assets	**1,639.0**	**1,837.7**	**5,386.9**	**8,333.7**	**8,377.4**
Accounts payable	54.6	38.8	50.2	72.0	85.7
Short-term debt	0	0	0	0	0
Long-term debt	1,485.4	970.7	1,037.6	2,537.6	2,537.6
Provisions & other liab	302.0	856.9	2,827.7	3,950.5	3,424.4
Total liabilities	**1,842.0**	**1,866.4**	**3,915.4**	**6,560.1**	**6,047.7**
Shareholders' equity	-203.0	-28.7	1,471.5	1,773.6	2,329.7
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0
Total equity	**-203.0**	**-28.7**	**1,471.5**	**1,773.6**	**2,329.7**
Net debt (Adj)	**1,056.9**	**716.2**	**-650.0**	**-715.3**	**-935.4**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	na	na	-44.2	-40.3	-40.2

Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
PE (x)	52.0	46.8	70.9	46.2	25.2
PB (x)	-45.9	na	8.4	7.1	5.3
EV/EBITDA (x)	38.9	33.6	25.2	14.8	9.0
FCF yield (%)	0.9	1.6	1.3	4.0	6.9
Dividend yield (%)	na	na	na	na	na
Payout ratio (%)	0	0	0	0	0
ROE (%)	na	na	8.1	7.1	12.6

Cashflow (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBITDA	221.1	294.4	347.6	556.9	904.0
Working capital	-57.3	-51.4	-57.8	20.6	40.0
Other	119.0	66.6	88.0	159.4	244.5
Operating cashflow	**282.7**	**309.6**	**377.8**	**736.9**	**1,188.5**
Capex	-186.5	-139.9	-224.2	-232.5	-349.3
Net acq/disposals	91.7	-128.4	-1,421.3	-1,500.0	0
Other	0	0	0	0	0
Investing cashflow	**-94.8**	**-268.3**	**-1,645.5**	**-1,732.5**	**-349.3**
Dividends paid	0	0	0	0	0
Financing cashflow	**-76.4**	**-216.9**	**2,700.9**	**2,560.9**	**-619.1**
Net change in cash	**111.2**	**-175.6**	**1,433.1**	**1,565.3**	**220.1**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**96.2**	**169.8**	**153.6**	**504.4**	**839.2**

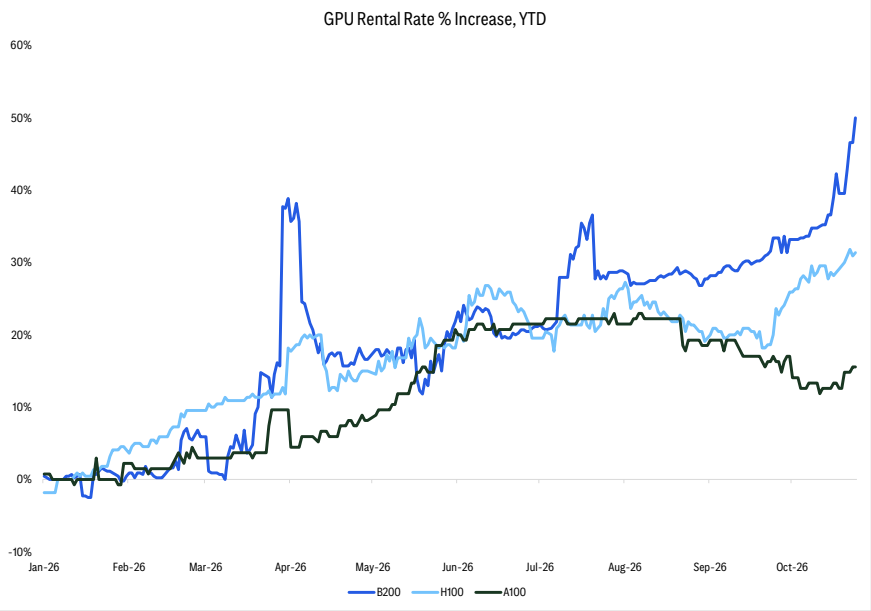
For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

Stock Set-Up, Sentiment

Shares are -25% in Oct'26 (+107% YTD) against the recent pressures in neoclouds (neoclouds -36% in Oct; +21% YTD) which comes as CRWV's bond yields spiked to ~15% (Oct 14th), sparking uncertainties on financing options for the broader industry for future infrastructure builds. However, we believe this rise in yield largely stems from the combination of rising rates (risk-free rates have steadily increased YTD, returned to ~20-year highs) and limited exposure to spot pricing which comes against high customer concentration and longer-duration contracts, resulting in risk to ROI. While we can appreciate the concerns, we believe DOCN is in a fundamentally different position given the company's vigilant efforts to improve leverage profile, limited customer concentration, lower exposure to long-term contracts, and growing opportunity in value-add software features, putting the company in better position to capture pricing upside and maintain healthy return profiles, service obligations, and secure financing. Parsing through the company's leverage, customer concentration, and contract duration (below) further reinforces our view that shares are unfairly caught in the neocloud trade down, offering an attractive risk/reward for a durable 40%+ CAGR asset.

- Leverage
  - After equitizing the 2030 converts in Jul'26, DOCN's pro forma net leverage sits at 0.7x, positioning them for upcoming buildout. While there is still ~95MW of capacity add on the horizon (through CY28), we see scope for the company to remain at/below the 4x threshold through the build.
- Customer concentration
  - DOCN's top 25 customers currently make up ~20% of revs vs. the high concentration of neoclouds (e.g. top 3 customers made up ~76% of CRWV revs in 2Q26). Aside from lower concentration risk, this should provide DOCN relatively higher pricing power.
- Contract duration
  - Meanwhile, DOCN has historically inked short-term contracts/deals where the weighted avg RPO life was historically at an average of ~2 years, allowing the company to quickly renew contracts and realize upside as GPU prices rise. This compares to the long-term obligations that neoclouds have committed to where agreements/deals with top customers often reach 5 years and beyond, limiting their ability to capture pricing upside.

Figure 1. GPU Rental Rates



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Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

3Q26E Set Up and Demand Read-Throughs

3Q26E screens undemanding from a seasonality standpoint, coming largely in-line with historical trends. This, coupled with constructive demand trends (GPU spot pricing up MSD since 2Q26 report) and encouraging progress of data center builds (both Richmond and Kansas City were launched ahead of target), adds conviction for continued upside to consensus/guide.

Figure 2. CY26E Revenue Seasonality/QoQ Growth (On Consensus)

CY26E Revenue Seasonality/QoQ Growth (On Consensus)

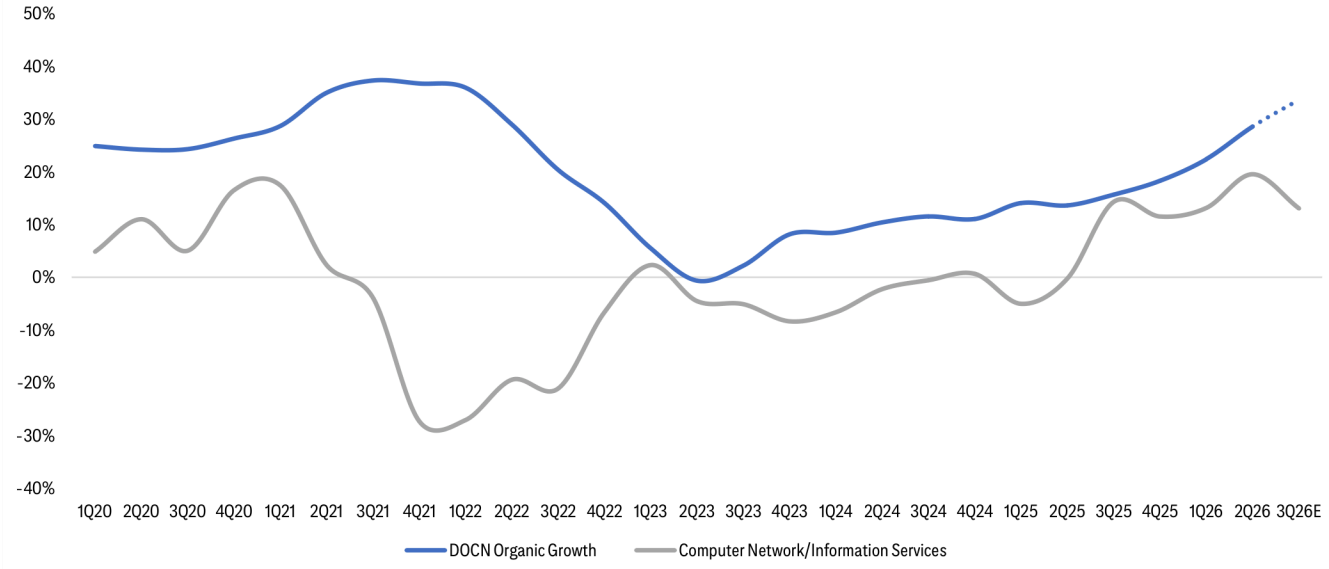
					vs. 5 year avg			
	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q
Seasonality	22%	24%	26%	28%	*-1.1pts*	*-0.3pts*	*0.2pts*	*1.2pts*
Sequential Growth	6%	9%	9%	9%	*2.5pts*	*3.7pts*	*2.4pts*	*3.6pts*

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet

Citi credit card trends

Updated Citi credit card trends show spending on computer networking solutions/info services remain resilient into 3Q26E (remained in double-digit % growth for 5 consecutive Qs). While spending trends did see a deceleration in 3Q26 (13% vs 20% in 2Q26), we remind that this comes against ~14pts tougher comps vs 2Q26 (-0.2% in 2Q25 and 14% in 3Q25). *(Please see "Card Insights General Description & Disclaimer and Methodology" above Valuation and Risks or Appendix A1).*

Figure 3. Citi Computer Network Credit Card Spend vs DOCN Organic Rev. Growth



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Source: Citi Research

Note: Please see "Card Insights General Description & Disclaimer and Methodology" above Valuation and Risks or Appendix A1.

A breakdown of DOCN's ARR trends also shows favorable trends on the non-AI business where ARR growth re-accelerated in 2Q26 while NNARR for the cohort is also encouraging. Ultimately, these demand readthroughs generally lean constructive, adding further support for upside to estimates and visibility for the company to exit CY26 at 40%+ rev growth, driving visibility for upward revision to current CY27 rev growth guide of 50%+.

Figure 4. ARR Details

ARR breakdown (In $M)

	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26
ARR	843	875	919	970	1032	1125
YoY%	*14%*	*14%*	*16%*	*18%*	*22%*	*29%*
NNARR	*23*	*32*	*44*	*51*	*62*	*93*
AI ARR	53	75	97	120	170	234
NNARR	*5*	*22*	*22*	*23*	*50*	*64*
Non-AI ARR (implied)	790	800	822	850	862	891
NNARR	*18*	*10*	*22*	*28*	*12*	*29*

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

Figure 5. Beat/Miss Analysis

Beat/Miss

	Rev	EBITDA
2Q26*	2.6%	10.3%
1Q26	3.2%	15.4%
4Q25	2.0%	7.8%
3Q25	1.5%	11.3%
2Q25	1.0%	4.5%
1Q25	1.0%	5.9%
4Q24	2.3%	18.0%
3Q24	1.0%	17.1%
2Q24	2.0%	15.2%
1Q24	1.1%	8.8%
4Q23	1.6%	12.0%
3Q23	2.1%	13.4%
2Q23	-0.1%	13.7%
1Q23	0.6%	7.8%
4Q22	1.3%	-2.9%
3Q22	2.6%	25.9%
2Q22	-0.5%	16.8%
1Q22	0.8%	-5.4%
4Q21	0.6%	4.9%
3Q21	2.9%	9.4%
2Q21	5.6%	5.0%
1Q21	3.4%	20.8%

Avg. Rev Beats	
LTM	2.3%
Historical	1.8%

Avg. EBITDA Beats	
LTM	11.2%
Historical	NM

*Estimates for 2Q26 Beat/Miss based on consensus figures before pre-announcement

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet

Scope on CY27 rev growth guide

Against healthy conviction for 2H26E, we believe there is growing scope for management to update current CY27E rev growth guide of 50%+ (intro'd during 1Q26 in May'26). Support here comes as the company has since announced multiple nine-figure commits while pricing continues to show upside, supported by steadily increasing GPU spot prices (up ~mid-teens% since May'26) and growing value prop of their software stack to enhance monetization of the infrastructure (e.g. newly launched agent features during Open Intelligence Summit). Here, key neocloud players have even called out negotiating short-duration deals in the $40-50M per MW range in 2Q26, albeit this is reflective of Vera Rubin capacity. Ultimately, we believe there is scope for CY27E rev growth guide to reach 60%+

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DigitalOcean Holdings, Inc.

Company description

Founded in 2012, DigitalOcean is a leading cloud computing platform offering on-demand infrastructure and platform tools. The company provides a simple and intuitive solution at transparent pricing, which has proven attractive for the developer and SMB segment of the market. Since then, the company has made meaningful strides tapping into the larger customer/enterprise cohort.

Investment strategy

We rate DOCN Buy. Our positive view comes against a product-focused leadership bench that brings a greater level of technical experience to drive much-needed feature enhancements of the platform, particularly adding more enterprise-grade capabilities, which add a new segment of addressable market. This new product-led growth (PLG) motion, coupled with vigorous customer and developer engagement efforts, addresses customers' key pain points. Together with an emerging inference opportunity and strong capacity build outs, DOCN is poised to capture multiple avenues of growth to deliver durable 45%+ topline levels, in our view.

Valuation

Given the company's healthy revenue trajectory/inputs coupled with a resilient margin profile, we apply an equally weighted EV/S and EV/FCF approach to derive our target price. In particular, our $190 target price is based on a 75/25 blend of ~17x EV/S and ~57x EV/FCF on CY27E.

Our terminal multiple of ~17x EV/S'27 sits ahead of historical avg as the new mgmt team is showing success in executing on key growth initiatives underpinning a path towards durable 45%+ topline growth. At $190, implied EV/S/G is ~0.3x which still sits at a slight discount to the group median. Our ~57x EV/FCF'27 is also ahead of historical medians as topline growth acceleration has also come at a profitable level. Meanwhile, the cap structure has also improved post the equity offering as it allows the company to reduce net leverage meaningfully against the upcoming capacity build.

Risks

Downside risks to achieving our target price include: 1) Competition further intensifies in the commoditized cloud hosting environment; 2) Hyperscalers make a more concerted effort to go down market and displaces lower-tiered vendors; 3) Mis-executions of the new management team, especially as the new CEO comes with limited public company leadership experience; and 4) New GTM and strategic efforts drive elevated costs, which could meaningfully impact the margin profile.

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Appendix A-1

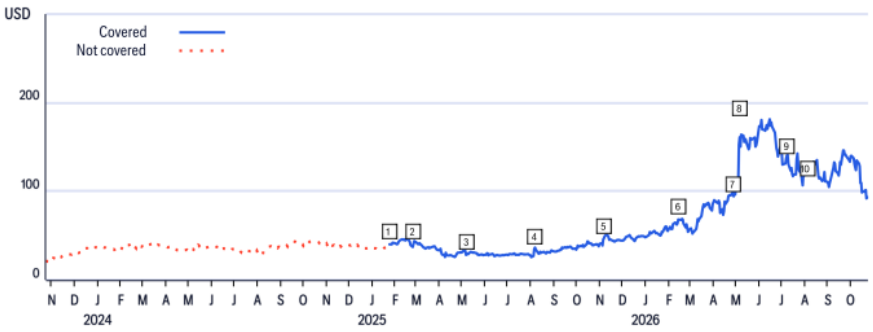
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DigitalOcean Holdings, Inc. (DOCN)
Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Mark Zhang



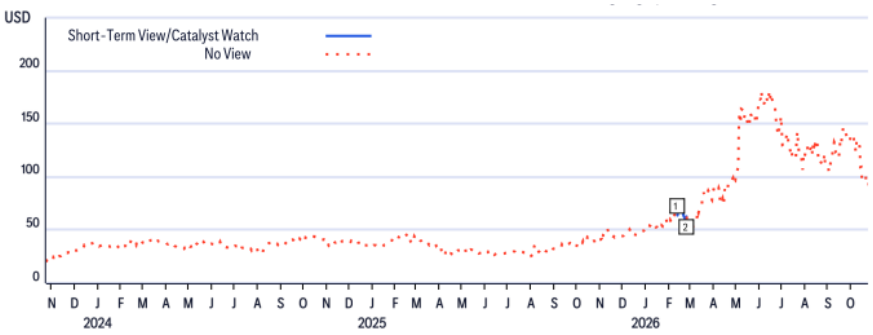
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1	24-Jan-25 03:35:58	*1	*45.00	40.18
2	25-Feb-25 17:32:57	1	*50.00	40.83
3	06-May-25 21:54:06	1	*40.00	28.25
4	05-Aug-25 19:03:43	1	*45.00	34.81
5	05-Nov-25 18:32:01	1	*55.00	45.81
6	13-Feb-26 01:49:21	1	*75.00	68.16
7	28-Apr-26 06:36:27	1	*115.00	94.38
8	06-May-26 08:21:09	1	*180.00	160.99
9	07-Jul-26 21:23:34	1	*185.00	137.04
10	04-Aug-26 18:00:49	1	*190.00	128.89

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

DigitalOcean Holdings, Inc. (DOCN)
Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Mark Zhang



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	12-Feb-26 20:49:21	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	63.78
2	24-Feb-26 18:38:39	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	62.74

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	39%	43%	30%	42%	38%	36%

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